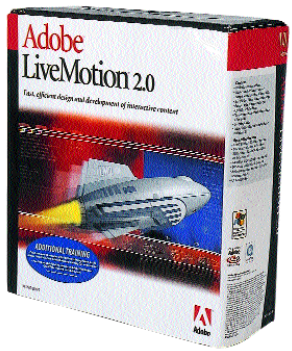
Adobe LiveMotion 2.0

Animate your world

LiveMotion 2.0, Adobe's latest offering, is pitted against Macromedia's Flash MX. It allows object-based animation—instead of frames as seen in Flash, there's a TimeLine that displays a list of layers within which you can make changes to the objects and also control how an object's attributes will change over time. Layer groups appear as a collapsible list of objects, so you can animate individual objects as well as the complete group. Changing the frame rate does not involve re-doing the timing of the movie—a 10 second animation will take 10 seconds irrespective of the frame rate it is played at.

Version 2.0 has a new feature called Time Scaling—by pressing [Alt], you can resize segments on the timeline and the key frames within those segments are automatically repositioned so that the existing animation is scaled to fit in the new time period. This feature allows you to make last minute changes without having to alter any of the animation.

LiveMotion offers you a great set of tools. The drawing tools offer four shapes—circle, ellipse, rectangle and square, to help you draw the basic layout of your animation. You can then play around with the advanced alteration tools such as opacity, size or distortion to give it any look you like. The software includes image editing features and integrates well with Photoshop and Illustrator, so you don't have to invest in a separate image editing application. It supports BMP, JPEG, PSD, ES, AI and TIFF formats.



It brings along with it a library with predefined styles, textures, sounds and shapes. You can store presets in the Styles palette and apply them later to objects in the same or in other compositions.

The Export panel allows you to set global quality options for all bitmapped objects in the document, as well as specific settings for particular objects. Hence, by reducing the quality of all bitmapped elements in the object, you can cut down on the size of the animation.

In version 2.0, the support for scripting has been beefed up. The scripting language is based on JavaScript. The script editor is extremely functional and relatively easy to use. Plus there are a number of sample scripts to make your task simpler.

To sum up, Adobe has brought LiveMotion to a level where it can be thought as a serious alternative to the Flash authoring environment.

SPECIFICATIONS

System requirements: Pentium III 600 MHz or faster processor, Windows 98/Me/2000/XP, 64 MB RAM, 50 MB free hard disk space, CD-ROM drive, 800x600 or greater monitor resolution

Adobe LiveMotion 2.0	A-
Performance	
Ease of use	
Value for money	
Features	
OVERALL	

Price: Rs 20,700
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